

Vertigo

No 838 June 2020



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

Wellington Section Monthly Bulletin

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**2020 PHOTO
COMPETITION
NOW OPEN**



Whangehu Hut, sunset, Mount Ruapehu.
Photo: Peter Laurenson

Chair's Report

June 2020

Save yourself; save the planet!

A few days ago I was helping myself to some leftovers from some catered meeting at work I hadn't been invited to. As is often the case, what remained were the gluten free and vegan options. 'Yuck. How can people eat that shit'. 'You can't live on crap like that'. A small group of people had gathered for the spoils. Their look of disdain on realisation that there was no meat or gluten on offer was obvious. 'That's not food' said one. 'Vegetables don't make you grow, there's no protein in them'. These were people with Masters degrees and PhDs demonstrating a mindless belief in the spin-doctoring of the meat and processed food industries. Mindless or not, they obviously didn't understand that promoting meat consumption is marketing.

As everyone knows, or at least anyone who cares to think about it, marketing is too often not based on reality. Did they know that even a standard iceberg lettuce contains more antioxidants than a serving of salmon or three eggs; that Alex Honnold is a vegetarian; that Arnold Schwarzenegger, along with a slew of the world's top endurance and power athletes, are vegan. How could that even be possible? There is nothing in vegetables except water.

Not knowing the health and fitness benefits of a vegan diet suggests there is a major failure in our education system – ok, so we already know that, but clearly the people who think they have to eat meat to grow or be strong lack an enquiring mind. Or perhaps these muppets don't care about their health (which we all pay for as taxpayers), but they should at least care about the state of the planet and the ongoing disaster of global warming, to which agriculture is one of the biggest contributors. OK, eat shit, but don't make your friends and family pay for the consequences. Even if you don't do it for yourself, do it for the planet and the next generation and go vegan.

You want to be as strong as an Ox?
Have you ever seen an Ox eat meat?



Send any comments to
wellington@alpineclub.org.nz
or tweet us @NZACWellington.

Simon Williamson
Outgoing Chair: NZAC Wellington



From the editor

I have a sneaking suspicion that Simon feels strongly about the merits of veganism. Do you agree, or not? Have your say.

Appologies for my Ruapehu visual dominance in this edition of Vertigo, but no-one sent me anything else to include. At least our volcanic national park was looking exceptionally stunning when I visited to get these images.

I look forward to receiving others' trip accounts in due course ... Peter

Section News

Gear Hire

The Section has gear for hire: avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, hammers, helmets, crampons, probes, PLBs, ice hammers (entry level). Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on return. To hire gear please fill in the form [here](#). You can find out more from [Carolyn](#).

Some advance notice, especially over the Christmas period, is appreciated as gear is in higher demand and often needs to be retrieved from the gear store. To collect or return your gear liaise with Genevieve.

InReach for hire



We suggest that all climbing parties carry a PLB as well as the InReach. If there is demand the section will purchase another one or two. The benefit of the InReach is that you can send and receive text messages, receive weather forecasts, and send an SOS in an emergency.

The InReach comes with 3 preset messages: 1. Delayed but everything is ok; 2. Starting our trip now; 3. This is where we are. Messages received from the InReach include a link that can be used to see the location. When hiring the InReach you need to provide an email address that will receive the messages and also advise if you'd like to adjust the preset messages.

The InReach can be paired using bluetooth to a Smartphone which has the Earthmate app loaded. This makes it much easier to type in messages. We recommend that you take a powerpack to keep the device charged and also only turn the InReach on when you need to use it to save battery power.

There's a \$50 deposit for hiring the InReach and a hire charge of \$20 / week-end. Additional charges will be incurred if you request weather forecasts or use non-preset messaging. [Contact Carolyn](#) kaz1963@gmail.com to find out more.

Discounted PLBs

skippersmate.co.nz offers a 5% discount to all NZAC members for NZ purchases of PLBs. Two brands are on offer - KTI SA2G and McMurdo Fast Find 220 (not always in stock). To use the discount, the coupon code on the website is **NZAC05** and the owner, Peter, asks you to send a copy of your membership card to peter@cooeebay.com

Section nights

It was great to resume our in-person section evenings on Tuesday 16 May. Jo Morgan attracted a crowd of 40 plus. Let's keep this level of turn-out going. Remember, our venue is now the Guest Room at the Southern Cross Tavern, 39 Abel Smith Street, from 6pm. This spot went down very well in May, offering great food and beverages.

Our July presentation

Tues 21 July, Aviette Musin will take us through her excellent avalanche awareness presentation in time for the serious end of winter. We ask a gold coin donation for this presentation, which is comprehensive and very informative. It may also save your life.

Section nights beyond July

Tues 18 August, Peter Ambrose will take us through his thinking behind and announcement of this year's photo competition winners.

Tues 22 September, David Barnes, a Wellington-based member on the Federated Mountain Clubs Exec team, will present an update on what's happening in the backcountry world – which is plenty in these globally warming, covid-ridden times of changes. He will also field any questions from the audience. Not to be missed.

Tues 20 October, Paul Maxim will present his climbing in the European Alps, including Mont Blanc.

Tues 17 November, TBC.

There are no section nights in December or January because we're too busy climbing.

If you would like to make a presentation at a future Section night, or have a suggestion about someone else to present, please let Peter know - occasionalclimber@gmail.com.

Accommodation on Mt Ruapehu

Our snowcraft courses for the past few years have been run out of the Manawatu Tramping and Skiing Club lodge on Whakapapa. We're always made to feel welcome and the lodge is well situated a short walk from the top of the Bruce Road. Membership to the club is extremely reasonable - \$35 per year or \$50 for a family membership. Members stay at the lodge for \$36 a night including food. If you're looking for somewhere to base yourself for your winter pursuits or rock-climbing over the summer months go to www.mtsc.org.nz/joining.php to find out more about joining the club.

Notices

Outdoor First Aid Course: \$290 per person

This 2 day course is essential for anyone who heads out into the bush or works in remote areas. It will cover basic first aid as well as emergency management of a first aid situation. NZQA standards 6400, 6401, 6402 and 424 will be covered on the course. Participants must be physically fit and complete a pre-course assignment. For those who just need to revalidate their OFA qualification, you only need to attend the second day of the course. The course will run in conjunction with Peak Safety in Lower Hutt. [More here.](#)

NZAC Instruction

Due to COVID-19 and staffing restrictions, the NZAC instruction programme has been reduced for 2020. Any available NZAC instruction courses are being run by NZAC Sections. [More details here.](#)

Member Discounts – Instruction courses

Some of NZ's quality training providers have come on board to offer some excellent NZAC member discounts on their Instruction Courses. Support NZAC and support local businesses, check out the member discounts below:

[Adventure Consultants](#)

[Alpine Guides](#)

[Outdoor Education NZ](#)

[Peak Safety](#)

[Queenstown Mountain Guides](#)

[Aspiring Guides](#)

[Snowy Mountains Climbing School](#)

[Alpine Recreation](#)

[Independent Mountain Guides Queenstown](#)

[New Zealand Snow Safety Institute](#)

RAL parking restrictions at Ruapehu

Skiers be aware. [Find out more here.](#)

New edition Guidebook: Mt Aspiring/Tititea and Otago Alpine Regions

Author contact details:

Nick Shearer: nicholastshearer@gmail.com, 021 023 42436

Neil Sloan: mckeesloan@gmail.com, 027 338 5560 or 03 443 1041

The four major blocks of peaks to be comprehensively covered are:

1. Humboldt Mountains – Barrier Range – Snowdrift Range - Bryneira Range - Waipara Range – Dart Glacier Peaks.
2. Forbes Mountains – Richardson Mountains – Rees Valley head.
3. Matukituki Valley Peaks.
4. Wilkin / Siberia peaks and peaks around to Haast Pass.

If you have been in these areas and can provide updated information, we want to hear from you. If you're a climber seeking a challenge and wanting to explore less-visited alpine areas on a fact-finding mission, we can help by providing a list of peaks that need revisiting.

Some of the things we are looking for include:

- High resolution colour photographs.
- Information such as errors and omissions in the current (2016) edition.
- Suggestions for improvements to the current edition.
- Changes to existing routes, access and huts.
- New routes.

A view north from Tukino Peak, Mount Ruapehu

Photo: Peter Laurenson



Coming Trips, Courses, Events

Covid 19 impact

In Level 1 trips are back on and scheduling new trips is possible.

NZAC Central Office has provided some guidance on what's appropriate, including being mindful not to take risks that could require a rescue; keeping track of who you are with on a trip (tracking); following Government requirements regarding personal spacing, washing hands, etc.

As new trips are proposed we will brief the trip leader on protocols appropriate at the time.

If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or to find out more, email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the Committee can help with advertising and logistics.

When	What and where
29 May - 1 June	Flock Hill bouldering On hold. New dates to be advised. Contact ericduggan@gmail.com
17 and 24 June	Banff Mountain film Festival 2020 Cancelled. But not necessarily dead in 2020 - watch this space.
24 - 26 July 31 July - 2 August 14 - 16 August 21 - 23 August	2020 Snowcraft courses Contact Nish Shah catchnishie@gmail.com Please note: a compulsory theory night for participants is on the Thursday night two weeks prior to each course. Participants will need to take the Friday afternoon off work to travel to the course venue.

NZAC instruction courses

Click for more details [Ice Climbing](#) [Ski Touring](#) [High Alpine Skills](#)

Annual Photo Wellington Section Competition

The 2020 competition is now open to enter, so polish up your favourite contenders and get them in.

Image submission requirements

- Images must be submitted to dropbox link <https://tinyurl.com/NZACWellPhotocomp>
- Please name your files following this format: Photographer_Category_Date.jpg and email a clearly file-associated caption and location to nzac.wgtn.photocompetition@gmail.com.
- Please ensure you have permission from people in your photos that their image can be used and possibly published in Vertigo.
- The closing date for the competition is the 31st July and the winners will be announced at the section night on Tuesday 20th August.

Image Specifications

- All images must have been taken and processed by the competitor and be his or her property.
- Images need not necessarily have been taken in New Zealand.
- Entries are permitted in digital format only. Files must be JPEG format between 500KB and 5MB (at least 2000 pixels on the long side).
- Digital processing should be mostly restricted to dust removal, cropping, resizing, global exposure and tonal adjustments. HDR, and exposure, focus or sequence blending are permitted. Obvious modification of images is not in keeping with the objectives of this competition and may result in disqualification.
- Images not meeting these specifications will not be judged.

Entry into the annual FMC photo competition

Category winners and selected honours awards will be entered by NZAC Wellington into the FMC annual photo competition in September (deadline 15th for clubs).

8 categories to enter. Up to 3 images per category:

- Alpine Activity
- Alpine General
- Alpine Nature
- Rock climbing
- Mountain and Climbing Culture
- Humour
- Alpine Kids
- Novice

[More details next page >>>](#)

Annual Photo Wellington Section Competition

Category details

Alpine Activity: climbing, skiing, whatever you do up high

Photographs where the main subject is people engaging in activity in the alpine environment (e.g. climbing, skiing, tramping, camping). Emphasis on careful composition and 'capturing the moment'.

Alpine General: scenery and views that make you want to come back

Photographs that display mountain landscapes. Images should be strongly composed with great light. Judges will be weighing technical excellence, colour, tone and detail along with the image's subject and composition.

Alpine Nature: the little gems of beauty along the way

Photographs of natural subjects in the mountain environment, where the emphasis is on artistic rendition. Subjects may include geological features, plants, animals, water, snow and ice formations, etc.

Rock climbing: hardest moves, slickest lines

Photographs of rock climbing and bouldering that have strong visual impact and creative composition.

Mountain and Climbing Culture: climbing life, places and people

Portray climbing life, places and people encountered by climbers. Entries might include travel photography (as long as it's strongly related to climbing) or documentary-style images, covering any aspect of climbing.

Humour: whatever makes you smile

Don't forget the caption. Particularly in this category it can make the difference.

Alpine Kids

Alpine / climbing-related photos taken by kids aged 6 to 14 (please include age of the child when submitting entries in this category).

Novice

Alpine / mountaineering / climbing-related photos taken by members who are not photo comp category winners in previous years or professional photographers. Pick your favourite that is not entered in any other category.

Judging criteria

1. Category relevance – is the shot on subject, or should it be in a different category.
 2. Technical competence/excellence – is the shot exposed well, right balance of dark and light, no burn out. Is depth of field used well/is the shot appropriately focused.
 3. Creativity – what is different about the shot. Does an idea/story come through in the shot. Does it draw the viewer in/have emotional impact. What makes it more than just a pretty snap - unusual angle, choice of exposure settings, inclusion (or exclusion) of person or object to give context.
 4. Difficulty to shoot – dawn/dusk, challenging light, difficult to reach angle.
1. and 2. are essential just to be accepted in category. 3. is what will define a winner, unless there are two winners, in which case 4., while not essential, might be the decider. Prizes will be awarded to the best photo in each category.

Judges profile Peter Ambrose

Peter is a passionate hiker and landscape photographer. He and his wife love travelling around the world and hiking some of the best mountains and landscapes this fantastic planet has to offer. We're lucky to be born and live in New Zealand, where we're blessed with such fantastic opportunities to capture nature's beauty in our own backyard. Landscape photography always takes Peter back to those moments, even years down the track.

Peter was also a judge for our 2019 photo competition.



It felt like a 'long time between drinks'. But finally, after almost exactly two months since New Zealand began Covid-19 Level Four, Shaun Barnett and I were driving along State Highway 1 into a promisingly radiant dawn. Not only were we now in the considerably freer world of Level Two, but the Met service forecast indicated calm clear weather for at least three of the next four days that we planned to be out in our tramping boots.

Our plan was to use the weather window to camp on Ruapehu's summit plateau, something each of us had done just once before. Then Shaun was keen to tag the tops of Tukino and Te Heuheu, before we took a new descent route for both of us down the Waihohonu ridge. Our start and end point for this loop was the 1,400 metre car park on the unsealed Tukino Village road, at the point where it bisects the round-the-mountain trail.



After slogging up through Tukino Village, where we paused to admire Don French's new pièce de résistance at TASC Lodge – a beautiful new double glazed feature window at the western end of his lodge, we traced the poled route, in the direction of Whangehu Hut. It wasn't long before hard, frozen snow encouraged out our crampons.

As keen photographers, it wasn't lost on us as we crested the ridge above the hut just as the magic began. Lovely light and colour, secluded tranquillity, but cold, and no stove to warm things up inside the hut. Nevertheless, it was great to be there with the hut all to our selves.

Our bubble burst about three hours after dark, when a young man appeared in shorts, soft trail shoes with strap-on four-point mini spikes and a 35 kg pack. Jamie from Hawke's Bay was tough alright, but ill-prepared for the conditions he'd encountered.

Next morning before setting off, we cautioned Jamie to be extremely careful if he chose also to ascend; pointing out that climbing down is usually harder than going up, so if in doubt, turn back. He was soon forgotten as we became immersed in our own climbing up the craggy ridge towards Cathedral Rocks.

It was a beautiful morning and stretches of the frozen snow provided the perfect surface for our crampons. In other places it was very hard, requiring care and concentration, as we alternated between white stuff and volcanic rock.

The summit plateau looked stunning in the bright sunlight. Certainly alpine, but not yet fully snow-coated, with patches of rich volcanic yellow, orange and crimson rock placing us in photographic nirvana.

By midday we were setting up camp on top of the 2,672 metre Dome. While getting organised, it was so calm that we could leave our gear scattered about as we pleased. And there aren't many 'rooms' in the North Island with a better view than our tent on the Dome.

was considerably more tenuous – a lot of very loose scoria and rubble, interspersed with patches of hard ice, mixed with plenty of exposure. At the first highpoint on the east side of the lake I lowered my tail and retraced my steps.

As a consolation I plugged up to the steep, iced-up crags that started about 30 metres beneath the summit of Paretaitonga, from which I enjoyed a panorama of the entire summit plateau, plus Ngauruhoe to the north-east.

With tripods ready, as Shaun and I enjoyed an unfolding dusk a tiny figure appeared on the snow east of the Dome. 'No way! I hope he's got a tent with him.' I said to Shaun, imagining the uncomfortable night ahead of us in our little tent if he didn't. 'At least he's still alive.'

Thankfully, Jamie did have a tent. He also had a Spiderman costume which, while shivering, he climbed in to so we could take photos of him for his young son back home. It was the first time either of us had spent any time with a comic-book super hero on a mountain top, and I've got to confess, it was a very cool photo op (see the May Vertigo).

Next morning, once packed up, we bid farewell to Spiderman, encouraging him to join a New Zealand Alpine Club snowcraft course as soon as possible. He clearly had drive and strength. And no doubt good balance too, considering the terrain he'd covered in his inadequate climbing gear. 'If you can learn some mountaineering skills before you get into a tight spot, you'll be much more likely to climb more mountains' I reasoned.

About an hour later Shaun and I began climbing up the northern crater rim towards Tukino Peak. While I'd been up Te Heuheu several times before, I'd only visited Tukino once, in July 2018. Then Tukino was a mass of rime ice, jutting out into a cavernous void. This time there was just volcanic rock, but the vertigo-inducing void remained. Shaun was suitably impressed.

After lunch Shaun felt like some downtime, but I was keen to use the conditions to do a little packless exploring. My plan was to circumnavigate Crater Lake, as I'd done alone once before in winter conditions. It soon became apparent though, that in the thinner autumn conditions, the route

This image, looking south from Te Heuheu



Though Te Heuheu is slightly higher than Tukino, its summit is much friendlier. We enjoyed some time up there in calm conditions, taking photos and marvelling at the views. By now though, cirrus tendrils had appeared, reaching across the sky from the north-west to announce a coming weather change.

It was time to continue. Our intended route down Waihohonu ridge didn't look particularly appetising - a world of craggy lines, punctuated by bluffs. It's ok when you can see the bluffs, but often they're hidden from above and 20-metre topo lines can easily hide them too. Shaun led off, picking an exemplary route down the broken ridge.

At 2,000 metres we arrived on a broad section of ridge with a great spot to pitch a tent. To our right was a big sloping slab of frozen snow, providing all the water we could need, and the view north to Ngauruhoe was superb. Though having been on the move for less than five hours, we called time anyway. By now the sky above was white with high cloud and there was plenty of interesting action going on nearer to earth to the west. The forecast was bearing out, so better to have less distance to walk back to our parked car next morning. Our afternoon was leisurely.

By early morning our light tent was getting a windy workout. Later, as we packed up camp, a gust pounced from nowhere, snatching away the tent bag, nearly doing the same to the partially collapsed tent itself.

Shaun donned crampons, shouldered his pack and headed down into a stream gully to retrieve the bag. I took a snow-free route further down the ridge, eventually reuniting with him a hundred or so vertical metres lower down.

With the weather change we now relished a new kind of photographic palette. Bleak, but still texturally magnificent, and when sunbeams breached the thickening cloud, drama unfolded.

Once again, the terrain proved deceptive. What appeared as low gradient, rolling scoria actually concealed stream beds fringed by those less than topo-20-metre high cliffs. Very low cloud put us in and out of a white out, so this added to our adventure.

Eventually we did reach the stream-bed, enjoying yet another visually spectacular perspective up to sheer rocky walls on both sides, at times a bit like a mini Grand Canyon. A couple of hours after leaving our camp site we hit the round-the-mountain trail and turned right, tracing this back to our car.

Met service had predicted that rain should arrive about midday. At 12 noon, just as Shaun unlocked the vehicle, it started to spit.



^ This image, looking south-west to Te Heuheu from 1,400 metres

Section Contacts

Powered by volunteers

We're always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. A lot goes on to keep our club going, virtually all powered by volunteers. On the back page is our "Club on a page" summary. It gives an at a glance description of all the things we do, how and why. Feel free to print a copy and pass it on to anyone who might be interested in becoming a member or volunteer. And if you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Role	Name	Contact
Outgoing Chair, course coordinator	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Treasurer	Eva Duncan	evaduncan@windowslive.com
Secretary, club liaison	Keith Munro	keithm@mtgelab.co.nz
Gear custodian	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Trip co-ordinator	Stacey Wong	staceycolleena@gmail.com
Section nights, Vertigo, Banff	Peter Laurensen	occasionalclimber@gmail.com
Banff	Emma Hayward	emmahayward@windowslive.com
Photo comp	Guy Dubuis	guy.dubuis@gmail.com
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Social media	Derek Cheng	derekcheng.nz@gmail.com
Patron	John Nankervis	
Rock drill overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 555 5893

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Past performance is not necessarily a guide to future performance.



Our club on a page

WELLINGTON SECTION



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

WHAT WE DO

FOR MEMBERS

Facilities

- * Huts
- * Gear
- * Library
- * Discounts

Training

- * Level 1-3 winter skills
- * Summer rock
- * Instructors

Climbing trips

- * Section
- * National
- * International

FOR MEMBERS AND WIDER PUBLIC

Publications

- * Website
- * Social media
- * Vertigo
- * Guide books

Events

- * Banff mountain film festival
- * Reel Rock
- * Photo comp

Networking

- * Section nights
- * Conferences and meetings
- * Lobbying

HOW WE DO IT

Organise, encourage, support, enable

Inform, entertain, promote

OUR RESOURCES

Volunteer time and capabilities, income from events and gear hire, national office support, sponsorship

WHY WE DO IT

Connecting & developing more climbing & mountaineering people, knowledge, skills & experience, thereby ...

... building
lifelong
friendships

... protecting
and improving
access to
alpine places

... sustaining
and growing
climbing and
mountaineering
achievement

... enhancing
alpine
safety

... building
appreciation,
enjoyment and
protection of
alpine places

Image and diagram Peter Laurenson www.occasionalclimber.co.nz